had brought from China. Mowu Angami was taken into custody. The defence minister, Sardar Swaran Singh, informed Parliament on 1 April 1969 that the security forces had captured Mowu Angami and his gang with their weapons. The prime minister congratulated Major General Navin Rawlley and the troops under him for this signal success. This operation was a great achievement for 8 Mountain Division.

However, Isaac Swu and T. Muivah broke up their group into small parties and managed to escape. Still, many of them surrendered later on. Overall, the performance of 9 Maratha LI during the extended four-year tenure was indeed praiseworthy, and even though we were a young battalion, we made a mark. Major Y.S. Shinde and Naik Balwant Sawant were decorated with Sena medals, and a few more gallant soldiers of the battalion got the chief of army staff's commendations. We did not have a single case of human rights violation or molestation in an area where the women of the Nocte and Wanchoo tribes, as per their traditions, did not cover their bosoms. We were very proud of our conduct as leaders, and for this we must give credit to our commanding officers who brought us up with a strict code of conduct, and impressed upon us that we were 'officers and gentlemen' above all. Lieutenant General Manekshaw, or 'Sam Bahadur', as he was fondly called by the rank and file of the Indian Army, was the epitome of 'the officer and a gentleman' tradition. He had inspired all of us so much as our army commander that we were ready to do anything to implement his strategy and directions relating to counter insurgency. We had outstanding successes such as the neutralization of almost the entire gang of Naga hostiles led by Mowu Angami. I realized that he was not only a great military leader, but also had many other qualities, such as being lion-hearted, particularly in adversity. He also had an uncanny sense of humour, and seldom lost his cool.